

0.0.1 Path to Tread

0. At Savatthi

1. “The wrong path to tread, O bhikkhus, and the right path to tread, I will teach. Listen to that and do mind it well. I will speak.” “Yes Bhante.” Those bhikkhus replied to the Auspicious One. The Auspicious One said this:

2. And what, O bhikkhus, is the wrong path to tread? In dependence on ignorance, O bhikkhus, there are sankharas. In dependence on sankharas, there is consciousness. In dependence on consciousness, there is name-and-form. In dependence on name-and-form, there is the six-sense-domain. In dependence on the six-sense-domain, there is contact. In dependence on contact, there is feeling. In dependence on feeling, there is thirsting. In dependence on thirsting, there is undertaking. In dependence on undertaking, there is being. In dependence on being, there is birth. In dependence on birth, there are old age and death, sorrow, lamentation, physical suffering, mental suffering and despair. Thus arises this entire amassment of suffering. This O bhikkhus, is called the wrong path to tread.

3. And what, O bhikkhus, is the right path to tread? From the complete fading away and cessation of this very ignorance, there is the cessation of sankharas. From the cessation of sankharas, there is the cessation of con-

sciousness. From the cessation of consciousness, there is the cessation of name-and-form. From the cessation of name-and-form, there is the cessation of the six-sense domain. From the cessation of the six-sense domain, there is the cessation of contact. From the cessation of contact, there is the cessation of feeling. From the cessation of feeling, there is the cessation of thirsting. From the cessation of thirsting, there is the cessation of undertaking. From the cessation of undertaking, there is the cessation of being. From the cessation of being, there is the cessation of birth. From the cessation of birth, there is the cessation of old age and death, sorrow, lamentation, physical suffering, mental suffering and despair. Just so, is the cessation of this entire stock of suffering. This O bhikkhus, is called the right path to tread.”